

Everyone Else • 10/39 • Maytham al-Tammar

The Date Seller. Maytham died refusing to insult Imam Ali. Five items, no event print, dateless.

One style for the whole line — Fraunces and Nunito Sans, cut paper, the person on a stamp. Still open where it shows: the fact panel is TO VERIFY and the return address is not set.

ENVELOPE — C5, 229 × 162 MM

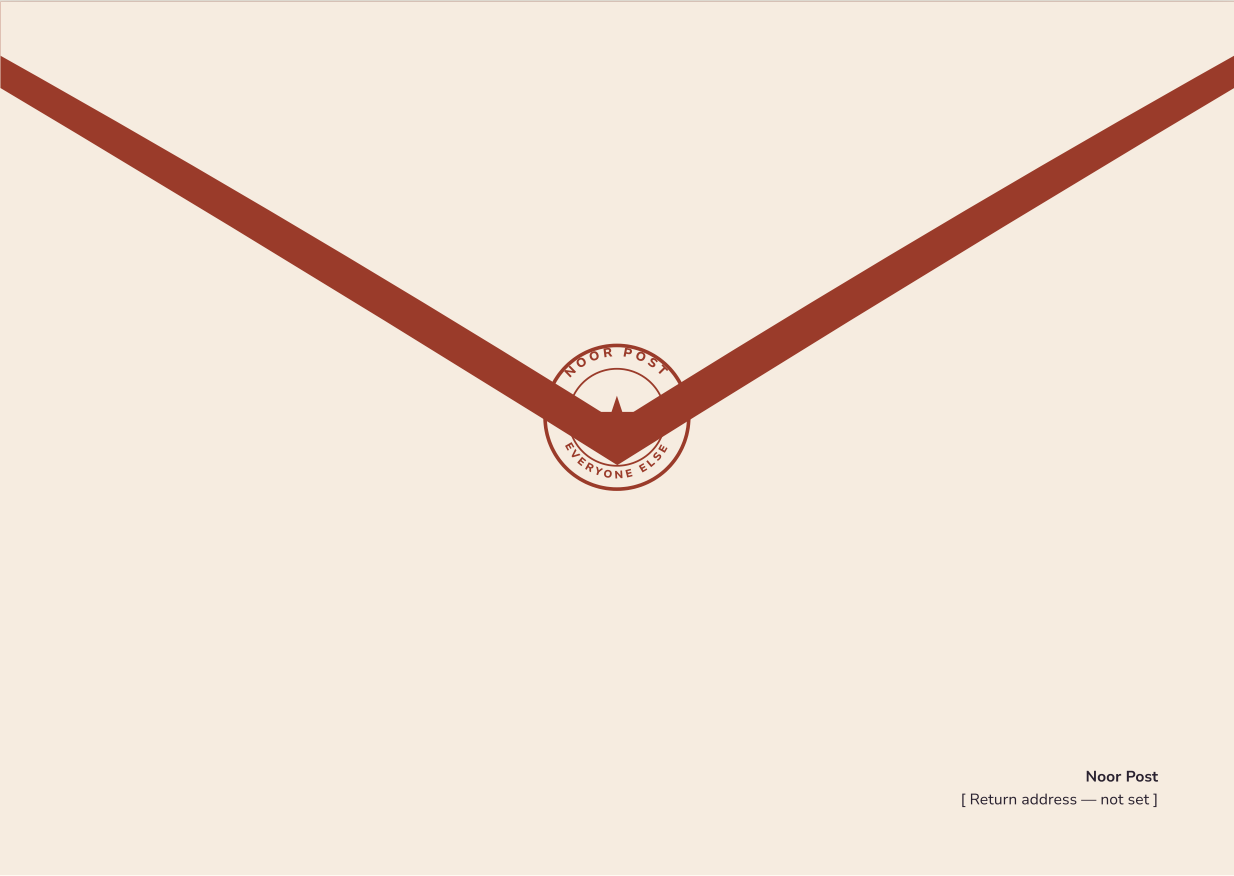
NOOR POST · EVERYONE ELSE

**Maytham died refusing
to insult Imam Ali.**

FOR

[Child's name]





INSIDE THE FLAP

EVERYONE ELSE ·
MAYTHAM AL-TAMMAR ·
INSIDE THE FLAP

Open together.

● is the grown-up. ○ is you.

- 1 The letter — read it out loud, ● and ○ taking turns
- 2 The hadith card
- 3 The print
- 4 The stickers
- 5 The postcard

1 · THE LETTER — ONE A4 SHEET FOLDED TO A5

Maytham al-Tammar

- **Who he was.** A date seller in the market at Kufa. He had been enslaved and was bought and freed by Imam Ali, and *tammar* — the date man — is the name that stuck.
- **What he was known for.** Being close enough to Imam Ali to be taught directly, while running a market stall. **He is one of the clearest examples in the record of an ordinary working person being a serious student.**
- **What he was told.** That he would one day be ordered to insult Imam Ali in public, would refuse, and would be killed for it. *This account is well known and much repeated; check with your family how it is told.*
- **What he did with that.** Kept the stall. Kept talking. Did not leave Kufa.
- **How it ended.** He was arrested under Ubaydullah ibn Ziyad, the governor of Kufa, and ordered to say it. He refused.
- **Why he is in this envelope.** *Maytham died refusing to insult Imam Ali.*

He was killed at Kufa, on the orders of Ubaydullah ibn Ziyad, shortly before Karbala.

The Date Seller



● is the grown-up · ○ is you · ●○ is together

- He sold dates in the market at Kufa. That is not a detail on the way to the story, that is the job he had, every day, for years. People knew his stall. *Tammar* means the date man — his name is his trade.

○ That's his whole name?

- It is what people called him, which is usually the truer name.
- He had been owned by someone, and he was bought and freed by Imam Ali, and after that he stayed close to him. He asked questions. He got answers. And one of the answers was about him.

○ About him?

- He was told, plainly, what was going to happen to him one day. That a government would want him to say something about Imam Ali, something insulting, out loud in public. And that he would refuse, and what it would cost him.

○ He knew?

- He was told, and he believed it, and then he went back to selling dates. **That is the part I would like you to sit with.** He did not run. He did not go quiet. He did not move city.

THE DATE SELLER · CONTINUED

○ **For how long?**

- Years. He is even reported saying it out loud in the market, to people who thought he was joking, while weighing out fruit for them.

○ **Would you have kept the stall? Say yes or no now.**

- And then a governor came to Kufa who did exactly what he had been told a governor would do. He was picked up. He was told what to say. It was not complicated — a sentence, said once, in front of people, and he could go home.

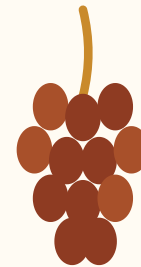
○ **Did he say it?**

- No. And they did what they had said they would do, and I am not going to describe it to you, and you do not need it described.
- He had been a slave, then a date seller, and the one thing the government of an empire wanted from him was one sentence, and it did not get it.

SAY THIS ONE TOGETHER

●○

**They wanted one
sentence. He had one
answer.**



Then the hadith card.

FIRST EDITION · 10/39

IMAM ALI SAID

**“No one will find the true
taste of faith before he
neglects telling lies whether
seriously or jokingly.”**

Imam Ali

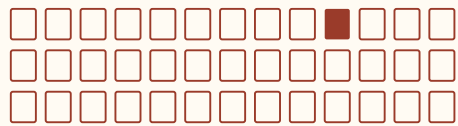


NOT A SILSILA SEGMENT · THIS SET HAS ITS OWN CHAIN

NOOR POST · EVERYONE ELSE

The other chain

The box holds fourteen cards, one for each of the Fourteen.
This set is the people around them: thirty-nine cards, collected
in any order.



First edition · thirty-nine cards

IN OUR WORDS

**You cannot really taste faith until you
stop lying — even as a joke.**

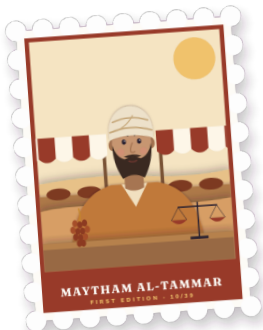
Noor Post's own words, not the translation.

Tuhaf al-Uqul, short maxims of Imam Ali, no. 104. Translated by
Badr Shahin, Ansariyan Publications, Qum.

Back — its own chain, no silsila number



Maytham al-Tammar





**We opened this one
together.**

• _____

○ _____

Post it back to us, or keep it. Either is right.

STAMP

Noor Post

[Return address — not set]
